GD2 - Assignment 2 - V2

Updates from Original Draft:

(Denoted with Pushpin stickers)

- Clarified that 2-3 of development can overlap with your Programming Tasks.
- Clarified the Task Names in the grading section.
- You CAN use your GS play tests for this. They run for about an hour, so you should also be doing a few tests outside of GS class.
- Added a new Task Type: Observation Task: Game Play Analysis

Dylan

GD2 - Module 2 - Observation and Testing

GD2 - Module 2

Overview:

For this assignment, you will be doing research on a topic related to the system you are building. This could be from several sources including:

- Former GS4 Projects (E.g. HexPunk, Rift City, etc)
- Unreal Documentation (Manual, APIs, Tutorials).

This is meant to support you in your programming tasks by giving you credit for work you are likely already doing. You should be drawing from either your assignment programming tasks, or topics from GD2 or Modern Tech.

Topics:

A short list of topics that would be good candidates is collected below. You should post your topics on the GD2 Figma to avoid overlap or collaborate. If you have a topic you would like to research that is not on this list, feel free to submit a brief proposal to the instructor for approval. Each Task should be focused on one topic.

- Animation Notifies + Montages
- Behaviour Trees
- State Graph
- Audio Systems
- Animation Systems
- Code Architecture (e.g. Health, Interfaces for communication, etc)
- Testing Tools
- UI Systems
- Input Systems
- Player movement systems
- PCG systems (in support of Level Design + Artists)
- Niagara systems

Some Suggested Observation Task Examples:
- Ability System in Rift City (How Animation Notifies and Montages are used for interaction and Effects)
- Audio System in Hexpunk
- NPC Behaviour Tree system in either Rift City or Hexpunk
- Researching the Unreal UI system by collecting documentation from the Manual and API
- Niagara System User Variables and how they could work with the Ability system.

See the Observation Task: Research & Documentation Creation: Card and Deliverable Details

Getting Started

GD2 - Module 2 - 2026

Getting Started:

Getting Started:
You should start with an **Observation Task: Research & Documentation Creation**. Once you complete at least one observation task, you unlock the option to do additional tasks to raise your mark, including running Playtests, or being a Playtester for others:

- **Additional Observation Task: Research & Documentation Creations:**
  - This could extend your original topics, or be a completely new topic.
  - ***(Max 5 Observations tasks per person for this sprint)***
- **Observation Task: Playtest Runner Overview**:
  - Running Playtest Sessions to test specific parts of the system or design.
  - *(**Max 2 Playtest Runner Tasks** Per Person for this sprint).*
- **Observation Task: Game Play Tester Overview**:
  - This gives you credit for participating in other students Playtest Runner Tasks.
  - *(**Max 1 Play Tester Tasks** per person for this sprint.)*
- **Observation Task: Game Play Test Analysis**
  - This pairs with the Game Play Testing Task and allows you to get credit for the analysis and collation of testing data.
  - *(**Max 2** **Game Play Test Analysis** Tasks per person for this sprint.)*

Grading and Marking Overview

GD2 - Module 2 - 2026

Grading and Marking:

Notes:

- **You must do at least 1 Observation Task to be graded**
- **Maximum 5 Observation Task: Research & Documentation Creations Tasks Total**
- **Maximum 2 Observation Task: Playtest Runner Overview Total**
- **Maximum 1 Observation Task: Game Play Tester Overview Total**
- **Maximum 2 Observation Task: Game Play Analysis Total**

- Each Task has specific deliverables, including posting to shared Figma pages, as well as a summary PDF that must be submitted to the Dropbox.

Grading and Marking:

- Each Task is worth 1 Point
- Each Task will be graded either:

1/1 = Successfully Completed - Documentation is clear and organized. Questions are answered, deliverables prepared and handed in successfully.

0.5 / 1 = Mostly Successfully Completed - Documentation is lacking organization. Questions are partially or insufficiently answered. Hand ins not provided.

0/1 = Not Completed. - Documentation is not provided or insufficient. Questions are not answered. Hand-ins not provided.

Points will get converted to your grade using the following table:

Points	Mark for the Assignment	Letter Grade
6	10/10	A+
5	9/10	A+
4	8/10	A
3	7/10	B
2	6/10	C
1	5/10	D
0	0/10	F

Examples:

- I completed 3 Observation tasks, as well as running a 2 hour playtest session (Playtest Runner Task) = 4 Point ⇒ A (8/10)
- I completed 1 Observation task only ⇒ 1 Point ⇒D (5/10)

Unlocks when 1 Observation Task is completed.

Observation Task: Research & Documentation Creation

Observe

Base

1

Max Tasks 5

Observation Task: Research & Documentation Creation:

needs investigation

Compiling documentation & links on a topic that you or someone else is working on in preparation or support of design or implementation.

Approximately 8-10 screenshots, slides, code snippets, articles, or diagrams (such as UML), and 150-250 words of notes and annotations is reasonable.

You can work individually, or in groups of up to 3 (for related topics).

Group Guidelines:
You can work in groups of up to 3 if you are researching related topics. Each student should be contributing a relatively equal amount.

Increase the quantity of the deliverables by 50% per student (from the baseline).

E.g.
1 Student = 8-10 images + 200 words
2 Students = 14-16 images + 300 words
3 Students = ~20 images + 400 words

Expectations:

I don't want to be creating additional work for you, so if you think about collecting notes while you work on your core programming tasks, I would estimate 2-3 hours of development would yield 1 observation task.

You can see the Modern Tech Figma Board for some examples of Figma Research. For example, the Montages page is a good example of an **Observation Task: Research & Documentation Creation.**

Deliverables:

Figma Notes - Shared on the GD2 or Modern Tech Figma

Exported and handed in to the Dropbox as a PDF.

Deliverable Example: Preparing a tutorial or support documentation on the use of a specific system or process that we'll need. It should be sufficiently complex, and include clear screenshots, annotations and instructions so that the average student could follow it and understand it.
- EG. A guide for how to import the 3D models, attach our ability system to the skeleton, and validate that collisions are still working.

Grading & Deliverables Details - Figma Notes

Deliverable Details: Figma Notes: Research, Code Documentation or Architecture Design

Deliverable Guidelines:

Provide 8-10 screenshots, slides, code snippets, articles, or diagrams (such as UML), and 150-250 words of notes and annotations is reasonable.

Deliverables Guidelines: (DO BOTH)
1. Posted on the public Shared GD2 Figma board for discussion and review in class.
2. Submitted to the Dropbox as a PDF (or a series of PDFs).

Paragraph and Sentence Structure Guidelines:

Paragraphs are clear and concise, sufficient context is given. The order of tasks is clear. Additional notes or asides are highlighted in a different color or with relevant sticker.

An average student should be able to follow along and make sense of it.

Format Guidelines:

Titles and headers are present where appropriate. Headers follow a logical hierarchy (e.g. h1 is title with h2 subtitle) in terms of size and visibility. Fonts are readable. You should have titles and subtitles that give some additional context.

(*E.G. Game balance in Sidescrollers throughout history or Introductory Guide to Behaviour Trees*) not (*Dylan's Report for Assignment 3*)

Naming Guidelines:
- The PDF should have a reasonable name (e.g **GD2_A2_DylanFries.pdf**).
- PDF's should NOT be placed in a ZIP (or other type) of archive file.
- Include your name, course(E.G. GD2) and assignment number (E.G. A1) as well as the date.

Deliverables Guidelines: (BOTH)
1. Posted on the public Shared Figma board for marking in class.
2. Submitted to the dropbox as a High Quality PDF (or a series of PDFs if they are too big).

- *Note: Don't make these images too big or they are hard to open and read. Do it as a set of images if you need to.*

Unlocks when 1 Observation Task is completed.

Unlocks when 1 Observation Task is completed.

Observation Task: Playtest Runner Overview

Observe

Base

1

Max Tasks 2

Observation Task: Playtest Runner Task

Feedback WANTED

Running play tests takes time an energy. This task gives you credit for presenting the game to folks and gathering feedback. This testing can include tests done for GS test days.

For each Playtest session, provide 3 specific questions for the play testers that you are hoping to get answered. Record their responses. They should be detailed and articulated to a reasonable degree (1-2 full sentences each).

E.g. ("It felt good") would be insufficient.
E.g. ("I thought the jumping felt great on the way up, but it got too floaty at the top and I would have preferred more air control") is a better example as it gives specific, actionable, and objective feedback.

You should run 12 people through a 3-5 minute demo for full marks. (~2 Hours of solid, focused testing if all at once, but feel free to break it up into different sessions.)

You should avoid having the same person test the same system twice, and you should only use the same Tester a maximum of 2 times for this task. The testers don't have to be students.

You should be getting Testers to test things that are relevant to your programming tasks.

FAQ:
Can I partner with someone to run a playtest?
Yes, if two people want to collaborate to run a playtest, you can do it together. You should be able to show that each person is contributing (E.g. One person is running the demo, 1 is observing). Both people can submit this for marks however.

Do the questions/ test focus need to be the same each time?
No, You can break up the tests across different systems or topics. It would make the most sense to do it in chunks though (e.g. 5 People test movement, 5 people test level design, 5 people test NPC's).

Deliverables:

1. Figma Notes Summarizing your testing notes posted to the GD Figma board (Individual testers names and specific feedback should be excluded).
2. A full summary of your testing including who tested, the date and time, and their feedback should be submitted as a PDF to the Dropbox.

Deliverable Example: Preparing a short report and presenting it to the class on your findings and observations. You should be able to back it up with data such as from our testing tools, or video footage for analysis (have it edited for brevity for presentation purposes).
- EG: Running a demo at the Game Jam on Reading Week and presenting to your class on your findings.

Observation Task: Game Play Tester Overview

Observe

Base

1

Max Tasks 1

Observation Task: Game Play Tester

This pairs with the Game Play Testing Task and allows you to get credit for doing testing of other peoples systems.

Guidelines:
You should answer their 3 specific questions clearly and articulately. Include specific detail and suggestions. Vague or unstructured responses may not be counted.

- *(See "Task: Running Gameplay Test Sessions" for details)*
- Each playtest should be at least 3-5 minutes.
- You can be a playtester for each other person a maximum of twice.
- You must provide specific, well structured feedback for it to count.
- Keep track of the feedback you gave, the time and date, and who the tester was, as you'll need it for your deliverables.
- You should do at least 20 Playtests for full marks. Feel free to forward would be Test Runners to other people once you hit 20.

Deliverables:

PDF Document - Include a list of who ran the play tests, the time and date, what their questions were, and your responses for full marks.

Deliverable Example: Preparing a short report on your findings and observations. You should be able to back it up with data such as from our testing tools, or video footage for analysis (have it edited for brevity for presentation purposes).
- EG: Running a demo at the Game Jam on Reading Week.

Unlocks when 1 Observation Task is completed.

Observation Task: Game Play Analysis

Observe

Base

1

Max Tasks 2

Observation Task: Game Play Test Analysis

needs thought

This pairs with the Game Play Testing Task and allows you to get credit for the analysis and collation of testing data.

Guidelines:

Provide a 1 Page PDF report on your play test findings. For full marks, you should be able to demonstrate that you added significant value in your analysis of the testing data. Support your conclusions with data, video or graphics if possible.

- Answer the following questions in your report.
- What conclusions did you draw from the test data?
  What worked well? What needs improvement?
- What actionable recommendations can you draw from the data? (3-5 actionable tasks)
- Back up your recommendations with an explanation of your reasoning. How did you come to the conclusions?

Deliverables:

PDF Document - Your conclusions at outlined above. Support this with video, data, or graphics if possible.

PDF Document - Include the play test data from the **Observation Task: Playtest**
- (See the *Observation Task: Playtest Runner Overview* guidelines for details).
- *(it will probably be there, but in the case that you are working off of someone elses test data or other edge cases).*